

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 38 Handout — Checks hang on the Environment. A deployment job is the hook. Slack thumbs-up is not an audit trail

4 - Continuous Delivery · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — Environment + check + deployment job

Object	Where you create it	What it does
Environment	Pipelines → Environments → prod	History, checks, optional resource links
Check: Approvals	Environment → ■ → Approvals and checks	Pre-deploy: named users/groups must Approve
Other checks	Business hours, REST, invoke Azure Function, exclusive lock	Literacy. Lab = Approvals
deployment job	deployment: ProdDeploy environment: prod	The only job type checks reliably attach to
YAML approver list	Does not live in YAML	UI on the Environment. Review the object, not a comment

Architecture B — where to put the speed bump

Environment	Check?	Why
dev	Usually none in a personal lab	Feedback speed. Still a real Environment object
staging	Optional	If staging is a shared proof, bump once
prod	Approvals: you (personal account)	The 3am self-own brake
Chat approval only	Never as the only gate	No run record; no Reject path

Architecture C — pitfalls that Approve in your head

Pitfall	What you see	Fix
job: with environment:	Check never fires; job just runs	Change to deployment: + runOnce.deploy
Wrong environment name	prod in YAML, Production in UI	Exact string match
Only ever Approve	First Reject feels like an outage	Practice Reject once; job must stop
Gate instead of tests	Human stares at a 200MB zip	Approvals catch process; tests catch product

One-liner to remember

Approvals are speed bumps before prod — annoying until the day they stop a 3am self-own. Reject is a path you must practice.

Step-by-step lab (personal Azure / Azure DevOps only)

Personal Azure DevOps org only. Project azure-100-labs. You are the only approver. Invite nobody from work.

- 1 Pipelines → Environments → New → name: prod (create empty). Open Approvals and checks → + → Approvals → add your personal account → Create.
- 2 Point a deployment job at environment: prod (extend Day 31 YAML or a tiny echo pipeline). Regular job: will not do.
- 3 Run the pipeline. Confirm it waits on Approval. Click Approve. Confirm deploy steps run.
- 4 Run again. Click Reject. Confirm the job fails/stops and does not execute the deploy script.
- 5 If Reject still deploys, the check is on a different Environment than the job. Fix the name; rerun.
- 6 Save both run URLs in docs/approvals-day38.md. That is the audit trail Slack never was.

deployment job hooked to environment prod (check is in the UI)

```
# Pipelines → Environments → prod → Approvals and checks → Approvals
# Approvers: <your personal account>   Timeout: 1 hour is enough for a lab
stages:
- stage: Prod
  jobs:
  - deployment: ProdDeploy
    environment: prod
    pool: { vmImage: ubuntu-latest}
    strategy:
      runOnce:
        deploy:
          steps:
            - script: echo "Only runs after Approve. Reject must skip this."
              displayName: Gated echo
```

Done checklist

- Environment prod has an Approvals check with your personal account
- A deployment job waited; Approve ran the echo
- Reject stopped the deploy script
- Both run URLs recorded; no work accounts invited

Tomorrow — Day 39

Multi-environment pipeline — Dev → Staging → Prod, same drop, approvals on the last stage.